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iPhone 14

A mixed bag

In what is arguably the cheekiest move in its recent history, Apple has substantially widened the gap between its Pro and non-Pro iPhone models this year. With the iPhone 14, the company has finally moved away from its long-held strategy of equipping its latest iPhones with the company's greatest chipsets. But, does that mean the iPhone 14 is essentially the same phone as the iPhone 13 Pro, or worse even the iPhone 13? Well, the answer is not quite simple. Read our review to find out if the iPhone 14.

DESIGN

Apple's design team in all its wisdom has decided to keep the design of the iPhone 14 pretty much consistent with what we saw with the iPhone 13 last year -- except for new colourways. The iPhone 13, sorry, we meant iPhone 14, comes with a flat aluminum frame and ceramic shield glass, durable enough to resist most drops and scratches. It is one of the most premium-looking phones you can get your hands on at the moment, which when gazed at from the front, or the back, looks like an absolute thing of beauty -- only if you've not been exposed to the iPhone 13 already. Holding it in your hand, the phone feels quite ergonomic, however, its flat edges and frame, don't make it the best phone in the business if you plan on holding it for prolonged periods while gaming or watching movies. Additionally, the phone is also IP68 rated, making it resistant to dust and water to a certain extent.

DISPLAY

With the iPhone 14, Apple is using the same 6.1-inch display that it used last year. This is an OLED panel, which can cover the DCI-P3 wide color gamut, and also comes with support for HDR10+ and Dolby Vision. This panel offers life-like colours, and is great for

watching videos and movies. It gets plenty bright and the fact that it's vibrant also ensures that it is great for consuming content on social media platforms such as Instagram. Sadly, the iPhone 14 still has a wide notch for housing the selfie camera along with 3D biometric sensors for the phone's facial recognition tech.

PERFORMANCE AND BATTERY

Despite housing a generation-old chip, the iPhone 14 generally offers pretty good performance overall. This is because of the A15 Bionic SoC found inside. We ran Call of Duty Mobile and Asphalt 9 Legends on the phone only to realise both games ran flawlessly on the phone. The same was the case for other GPU benchmarks such as GFXBench and 3D Mark WildLife. It was here that the iPhone 14 did take a slight lead over the scores we've previously seen on the iPhone 13. The reason, obviously, is the extra GPU core. In Antutu and Geekbench the results were again good. When compared to the iPhone 14 Pro Max, the results were about 20 per cent lower than the new iPhone powered by the A16 Bionic SoC. Coming to the



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battery, the iPhone 14 proved to give us slightly better battery life compared to the iPhone 13.

CAMERAS

In the camera setup, we have a 12MP primary wide-angle lens that's sat next to a 12MP ultra-wide lens aided by Apple's introduction of the new Photonic Engine, which Apple claims further improves low-light performance and colour reproduction on photos. In well-lit conditions, the pictures were sharp and packing plenty of details. The autofocus was on point, and the resultant pictures offered good dynamic range and close-to-life colour tones. But, in low-light conditions, the iPhone 14 captured more detail and the Photonic Engine

processed images also have less noise in them. In our time with the TrueDepth camera, we found this camera to click some really good selfies with accurate skin tones and plenty of details.

VERDICT

At Rs 79,990, and some bank discounts are thrown into the mix, the iPhone 14 is definitely worth checking out. While the upgrades on offer aren't substantial enough to recommend the phone if you are coming from an iPhone 13, they are good enough if you are coming from a slightly older iPhone, or from a high-end Android device. In that case, the iPhone 14 could really be a good buy for you.

—Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.1 inch Super Retina XDR | **CAMERAS:** 12MP Main & Ultra Wide with Autofocus on TrueDepth front camera | **VIDEO:** 4K@24/25/30/60fps, 1080p@25/30/60/120/240fps, HDR, Dolby Vision HDR (up to 60fps), Cinematic mode (4K@30fps), stereo sound rec. | **CHIPSET:** A15 Bionic chip with 5-core GPU | **5G CONNECTIVITY:** Yes | **OS:** iOS 16, upgradable to iOS 16.1 | **CPU:** Hexa-core (2x3.23 GHz Avalanche + 4x1.82 GHz Blizzard) | **GPU:** Apple GPU (5-core graphics) | **USB:** Lightning, USB 2.0 | **BATTERY:** Li-Ion 3279 mAh, non-removable (12.68 Wh) | **COLORS:** Midnight, Purple, Starlight, Blue, Red

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